Turn uncertainty into clear decisions.

24 questions that align everyone's expectations and stop costly scope creep, before a single line of code is written. You don't need every answer. You need to know which ones are still open.

1 · ANSWER
Answer what you can and tick **Known** or **Unsure**. Unsure is useful: it shows where the risk is.

2 · DECIDE
Write one clear **decision** for each section. If you can't, that's the first thing to settle.

3 · AGREE
Fill in the scope summary overleaf and share it with everyone involved before work begins.

01 The problem

What problem are we solving, in one sentence?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
What does it cost today in time, money or customers?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Why does it need solving now rather than later?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision The one problem we solve first: _____

02 The people

Who will use it every week, and who only occasionally?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
What are the three tasks they most need to finish?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Any accessibility, language or device needs?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision Our primary users are: _____

03 Success

What should be faster, cheaper or easier afterwards?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Which number will prove it worked, and by when?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
What must never get worse (speed, security, brand)?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision We'll call it a success when: _____

04 First release

Which three things must work on day one?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
What can wait for a second phase?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
What is definitely not part of this project?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision Our 3 day-one must-haves: _____

05 Systems and data

Which tools, platforms or data must it connect to?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Who owns that data, and is it clean enough to use?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Any security, privacy or compliance rules to follow?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision Day-one integrations: _____

06 AI, if relevant

Which repeat task could AI take off your team?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Where must a person review or approve the result?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Would a simpler rule or automation do the job?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision AI helps with / a person checks: _____

07 Budget, time and sign-off

What budget range are you comfortable with?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Is there a date or event it must be ready for?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Who gives feedback, and who makes the final call?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision Budget, date and sign-off: _____

08 Guarding against scope creep

How will new ideas be captured without changing this release?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
Who can approve a change to scope, budget or date?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure
What would make us pause and re-plan?	☐ Known ☐ Unsure

Decision New requests are handled by: _____

Agree it once.
Avoid surprises later.

Turn your decisions into one shared page. When everyone signs up to the same scope, budget and change rule, expectations stay aligned and the project stays on track.

Our scope summary

The problem
One sentence

Primary users

Success measure
The number, and by when

Day-one must-haves
No more than three

Not in this release

Budget range

Target date

Decision-maker
One named person

Our change rule: new requests go on a "next phase" list. They only enter this release if the decision-maker agrees what they replace, or approves the extra time and budget.

Client name, signature and date

Delivery partner name, signature and date

Scope creep red flags

- **"Can we just add one more thing?"**
  Every addition has a cost. Put it on the next-phase list first.
- **No single decision-maker**
  Feedback from five people with no final say slows everything down.
- **Success that can't be measured**
  If you can't say when it's done, it never is.
- **"We'll know it when we see it"**
  Agree examples or a prototype before the build starts.
- **A budget agreed before the scope**
  Fix the scope first, then the price, so both stay honest.

What happens next

1. **Free 30-minute scoping call.** Bring this checklist, even half filled in. We'll help you settle the open questions.
2. **Fixed quote within 48 hours.** One price and one timeline, agreed before any work starts.
3. **Weekly demos.** You see working progress every week, so nothing drifts from what you agreed.

Book your free scoping call →

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